

SYED ZARAK HASSAN

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Professional Summary

Compliance and Information Security professional with 1+ year of hands-on GRC experience across ISO 27001, ISO 9001, Cyber Essentials, vendor risk management, and endpoint security. Delivered an end-to-end MDM migration across 250+ endpoints with zero downtime, reducing IT support tickets by 40%, and managed 50+ third-party vendor audits to support customer assurance and risk management, also built production-grade GRC tooling deployed in a live audit environment. Currently completing an MSc in Cyber Security. Seeking a GRC, Information Security, or client-facing security role.

Technical Skills and Core Competencies

Frameworks and Standards: ISO 27001, ISO 9001, Cyber Essentials, NIST Framework, CIA Triad.

GRC and Compliance: Risk Register, Vendor Risk Management, Third-Party Risk Management, DPA Tracking, GDPR, Access Control, Auditing, Data Privacy, Business Continuity Planning.

Security Operations: IAM, Endpoint Security, Incident Response, DLP, Vulnerability Management, Security Awareness and Training, Security Controls.

SIEM and Tooling: Splunk, Chronicle, Suricata, Wireshark, tcpdump, VirusTotal, BitDefender GravityZone.

MDM and IT Tools: Kandji, Pulseway, Vanta, Cakewalk, Jira.

Programming and OS: Python, MySQL, Linux (Mint and Ubuntu), macOS, Windows.

Professional Skills: Project Management, Stakeholder Engagement, Pre-Sales Support, Client Onboarding, Strategic Planning.

Professional Experience

Compliance Analyst - Thrive Learning, Nottingham, UK

September 2025 – Present | Fixed-term contract, September 2026

Key Achievements:

- Delivered end-to-end MDM migration to Kandji for 250+ endpoints with zero downtime, reducing IT support tickets by 40%.
- Reduced DPA time-to-approval by 70% through development and ownership of a company-wide DPA tracking system.
- Supported successful ISO 9001 Stage 1 audit pass by designing 6 end-to-end business process flows and executing internal continuous improvement checks against seasoned external auditors.

Responsibilities:

- Owned third-party risk management and compliance audits for 50+ vendors in Vanta, maintaining up-to-date risk classifications and supporting ongoing customer assurance programmes.
- Maintained core GRC risk registers and security controls across vendor, asset, access control, and risk domains, identifying and remediating gaps to ensure continuous audit readiness.
- Managed 75+ application ownership records in Cakewalk, assigning security and business owners to ensure accountability across the application estate.
- Developed and maintained the company-wide DPA tracker, coordinating supplier and contract lifecycle activities with procurement to support GDPR compliance, data privacy obligations, and spend optimization.
- Delivered a critical RFI response for a high-value prospect by mapping security controls to client requirements, contributing directly to deal closure and successful client onboarding.
- Streamlined cross-functional compliance deliverables by completing customer due-diligence processes and security questionnaires, improving response speed and quality across the business.
- Monitored endpoint health and supported IT operations via Pulseway MDM, managing proactive incident tracking and Jira ticket resolution for end-user devices.
- Contributed to business continuity planning documentation as part of ISO 9001 governance and third-party risk management initiatives.

Lead Project Manager - Nexique Design Labs, Pakistan

September 2021 – August 2024

- Managed end-to-end project delivery for 15+ clients across onboarding, requirements gathering, and execution, generating \$8,500+ in revenue with a near-100% client satisfaction rate.
- Led and mentored a 5-person team, developing standardised onboarding workflows and operational processes to ensure consistent delivery quality.

Projects & Tools

VenderScope — Continuous Vendor Risk Intelligence Platform (Independent Project)

github.com/darkyzowo/venderscope | Live Demo: venderscope.vercel.app

- Built a full-stack vendor risk monitoring platform in Python and React that replaces point-in-time annual audits with 24/7 passive threat intelligence, aggregating live data from HIBP, NVD/NIST, Shodan, and Companies House into a weighted risk scoring engine (0-100) with CRITICAL/HIGH/MEDIUM/LOW classification.
- Designed the platform to complement existing GRC tooling, using it alongside Vanta in a real supplier audit workflow to cross-reference vendor threat posture, surfacing exposed infrastructure, active CVEs, and breach history that traditional compliance platforms do not continuously monitor.
- Implemented UK-native governance checks via Companies House API to flag financial distress, overdue filings, and director changes as third-party risk signals, and integrated Shodan to detect dangerous open ports on vendor infrastructure such as RDP, SMB, and MongoDB.
- Engineered audit-ready PDF export reports structured for ISO 27001 Annex A and Cyber Essentials reviews, with a risk score drift timeline enabling reviewers to assess how a vendor's security posture changes over time rather than at a single point in audit.

Secure Web Application Development: SpeedyRentals (University Project) - github.com/darkyzowo/SpeedyRentals

- Designed and developed a full-stack car rental web application with security embedded across the entire development lifecycle, from initial design through to testing and deployment.
- Implemented OWASP-aligned secure coding practices throughout, including input validation, authentication controls, and protection against common web vulnerabilities.
- Built user authentication, password recovery, and role-based access controls using Firebase, applying the principle of least privilege across admin and end-user access flows.
- Integrated a secure payment form and booking management system, ensuring sensitive data handling aligned with GDPR requirements.

Education

Master of Science in Cyber Security

Nottingham Trent University, UK | January 2025 – December 2026 (Expected)

- **Dissertation:** Investigated whether diagrammatic techniques improve auditor comprehension of complex systems, combining case studies and interviews to demonstrate measurable improvements in understanding at small scale.
- **Relevant modules:** Network Security, Digital Forensics, Secure Software Development and Ethical Hacking.

Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering

Iqra National University, Pakistan | February 2020 – February 2024

Certifications

Google Professional Cyber Security Certificate (2024) / [Coursera and Google](https://www.coursera.org/certificates/google-professional-cyber-security)

- Hands-on labs in Linux, MySQL, and Python focused on incident response, log analysis, and network security fundamentals.

SOC Member (2024) / [LetsDefend](https://letsdefend.com) and [HackTheBox](https://hackthebox.com)

- Completed a hands-on SOC Analyst Learning Path through LetsDefend, focused on real-world threat detection, incident investigation, and response within a simulated Security Operations Center (SOC) environment.
- Analyzed and resolved real-world cyber attack scenarios, including Phishing, Malware detection, and Web Attacks.